

Communication Skills

Quiz 1 / Mid-sem study guide

Course LA10760 · Dr. Srirupa Chatterjee · summarised from lectures L2-L8 plus the writing lecture notes

What the last slide says about the quiz

- **Multiple-choice questions, no negative marking** (so never leave one blank).
- Questions come from the **general content of the lectures delivered in class**.
- **No specific questions from the short stories** (Civil Peace, The Fly). Their plot and style still matter as examples of lecture ideas.
- There will also be **comprehension passages with questions**.
- Mode: hard copy, answered in the classroom (the slide says LHC-4), 12:00 to 1:00 pm.

The slide text reads "Sept 19, 2025, Friday". That looks like last year's date carried over, so check your real date and venue with the course announcement.

How to use this guide

- **Page 2** is the one-page cheat sheet: read it last thing tonight and again tomorrow.
- **Sections 1-9** follow the lectures in order. Diagrams are redrawn from the slides so you can see the shapes (plot types, argument outline, Burkean parlor).
- **Section 10** has quick tips for comprehension passages (these are general tips, not from the slides).
- **Section 11** is a 50-question MCQ drill with an answer key. Do it cold, then re-read whatever you missed.

#	Section	Source
1	Communication and idea generation	L2
2	Achebe, Nigeria and African storytelling	L2, L3
3	Plot: literature and communication	L3
4	Modernism, modern art and Camus	L4
5	The two stories at a glance	L3, L5
6	Arguments and scholarly communication	L6
7	Writing an essay: templates and style manuals	L7
8	Writing well: final points (tense, parallelism, passive voice)	L8
9	Writing rules, AI ethics, plagiarism	Lecture notes
10	Comprehension-passage tips	General
11	Practice MCQs and answer key	Drill



One-page cheat sheet

Memorise these lists and dates

Communication process

- Sender → Encoded message → Receiver → Decoded message
- Communication is not merely conveying information; it is often **socially negotiated problem solving**
- Brainstorming: intuitive, collaborative, many perspectives, leads to evaluation and organisation

Aristotle's 5 common topics

- **Definition** (genus/division)
- **Comparison** (similarity/difference/degree)
- **Relationship** (cause/effect, antecedent/consequence, contraries/contradictions)
- **Circumstance** (possible/impossible, past fact/future fact)
- **Testimony** (authority, testimonials, statistics, maxims, law, precedents, examples)

5 plot types

- **Linear**: Freytag's pyramid
- **Circular**: Hero's Journey (*Ramayana*, *Prodigal Son*)
- **Non-linear**: many epics, contemporary plots
- **Open-ended**: end has infinite possibilities, no resolution
- **Interactive**: modern theatre, breaking the fourth wall
- Freytag: exposition → rising action → climax → falling action → resolution/catastrophe

Choosing a plot

- Your role and audience expectations
- Audience's requirements
- Channels of communication
- End goal

Writing mistakes (notes + L8)

- Tense discontinuity: keep one main tense; shift only to mark a real change in time
- Passive voice: subject is acted upon; prefer active. Passive is fine when the actor is unknown, irrelevant, to be left vague, or for a general truth
- **Parallel structure**: pairs and lists follow the same grammatical pattern
- Subject-verb agreement; consistent pronouns (person and number)
- Modifier errors; wordiness; incomplete sentences; too many ideas in one sentence
- Gender-inclusive language; avoid abbreviations (&, etc., e.g.)
- **Readerly writing**: simple and precise, grammatical, chronological, no contradictions, no complexity

Modernism

- Precursors: **Marx** (Materialism), **Freud** (Unconscious), **Darwin** (Evolution)
- Western movement, late 19th to early 20th c. (1900-1920s)
- Rebellion against traditional values; questions all-powerful God and moral codes
- Art: Cubism (Picasso), **Dada** = 'nonsense' (Duchamp), Surrealism (Breton, Paris)
- Camus, *The Myth of Sisyphus* (1942): the **absurd**; absurd hero

Arguments

- Keywords: **5-7**
- Thesis / topic sentence: **25-30 words**
- Outline: thesis first; major points **I, II, III**; supporting **A, B, C**; then **1, 2, 3**; then **a, b, c**
- Formal disagreement: use facts and evidence; no personal attacks; humour only to defuse, never to mock

Burkean parlor

- Kenneth Burke, *The Philosophy of Literary Form* (1941)
- You arrive late to a discussion already going; you listen, join in, leave, and it continues
- = scholarly communication across generations; accurate recording of data is key; we fill gaps in existing scholarship

Astronomy chain

- Aristotle (384-322 BC): Earth at centre
- Ptolemy (100-170 AD): **geocentric**
- Copernicus (1473-1543): **heliocentric**, round orbits
- Galileo (1564-1642)
- Kepler (1571-1630): elliptical orbits
- Newton: a century later

Essay skeleton (They Say, I Say)

- Intro: begin with a debate, state your position, refer to critical sources
- Body positions: disagree / agree + add / agree and disagree / undecided
- Conclusion transitions: as a result, after all, in short, finally, to summarize, in sum, simply put
- Conclude: repeat yourself, but differently
- Style manuals: IEEE, APA (technical); MLA, Chicago, Harvard, APA (humanities)

Key dates

- Achebe 1930-2013; *Things Fall Apart* 1958
- Nigerian civil war 1967-70; 'Civil Peace' 1971
- Mansfield 1888-1923
- Wordsworth Preface 1800
- Fish, *How to Write a Sentence* 2012
- Picasso, *Portrait of Wilhelm Uhde* 1910

1

Communication and idea generation

Lecture L2 · General strategies for cogent writing



Success = the decoded message matches what the sender meant (PLOT is what makes it clear)

The communication process from L2

The literary narrative is treated as a story, event or concept to be communicated. The lecture then asks: **what is successful communication?** Answer: a well-developed **plot**.

Ideas about sentences and poetry

- **Stanley Fish**, *How to Write a Sentence: And How to Read One* (2012). Before words slide into their slots they are just discrete items. Examples come from Mark Twain ("If you tell the truth, you don't have to remember anything"; "Buy land, they're not making it anymore"). A student sentence, "I was already on the second floor when I heard about the box," generates **anticipation** because it makes the reader want to know more. Fish's point: following grammar rules is important, but **precision of thought** is equally necessary.
- **Wordsworth**, Preface to *Lyrical Ballads* (1800): poetry is the "spontaneous overflow of powerful feelings" that takes its origin from emotion recollected in tranquility.

Generating ideas

- **Define the problem and your task:** (a) identify what has to be addressed, (b) determine how to address it.
- Note: communication is **not merely conveying information**, and good communication is often **socially negotiated problem solving**.
- **Brainstorming** is primarily intuitive, can be collaborative, generates numerous perspectives, and leads to evaluation and organisation.

Exploring the subject: Aristotle's common topics

Topic	Sub-ideas to think with
Definition	Genus / division
Comparison	Similarity, difference, degree
Relationship	Cause, effect, antecedent, consequence, contraries, contradictions
Circumstance	Possible, impossible, past fact, future fact
Testimony	Authority, testimonials, statistics, maxims, law, precedents, examples

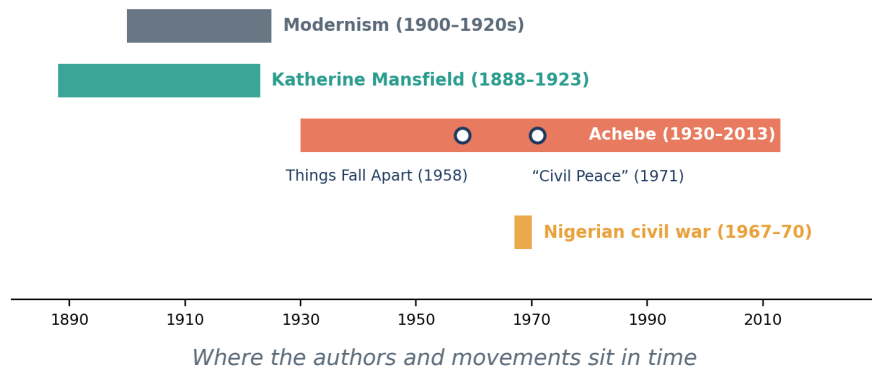
Identifying audiences and purposes

- Identify the **uses** of your communication and the **routes** it will travel.
- Consider the impact of co-operative, controversial and ethical ideas.
- Consider the impact of **distortion, incompleteness, inaccuracy and bias**.

2

Achebe, Nigeria and African storytelling

Lectures L2 and L3



Chinua Achebe (1930-2013)

- Nigerian, from the **Igbo** community. *Things Fall Apart* (1958) is his magnum opus.
- Active in Nigerian politics; worked to support common people during the civil war; professor of **Africana Studies at Brown University**, USA.
- "Civil Peace" (1971): the **title is ironic**; it shows Achebe as writer and activist, comments on violence and corruption within the state, shows devastation during war, and ends as a tale of optimism and human resilience.

The Nigerian civil war (1967-70)

- A civil war is a war between two factions within the same nation, or two countries that once formed a nation.
- Also called the Nigerian-Biafran war: **Biafra** became a self-proclaimed republic but was finally reabsorbed into Nigeria.
- Chief causes were **cultural and economic**, arising from an **arbitrary division of the continent by the British**.

The short story and Africa

- Draws from an **oral heritage**.
- Colonization: the slave trade and slave narratives in the 18th century.
- Imprints of the **Negritude movement** in the 20th century: a political and literary movement started in **France by the African diaspora in the 1930s**, against French racism and rule (France was the second-largest colonizer after Britain).
- **Achebe's position: both oral storytelling and Negritude.**

3

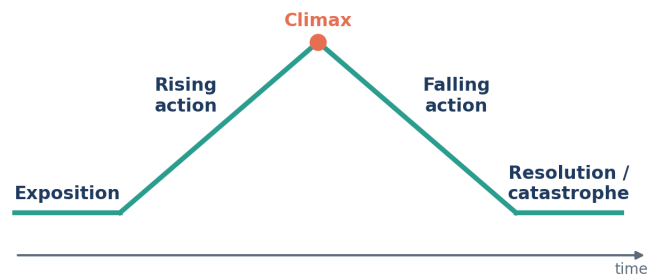
Plot: literature and communication

Lecture L3

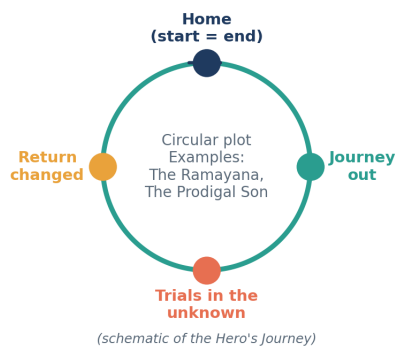
Plot in literature

- Literature (imaginative communication) is about **narratives / stories**. Every story has a **goal or conclusion**, open or closed.
- The goal is to convey a message, idea or situation. That message is **always open to interpretation**.
- The goal (communicating clearly) is reached through **plot**: the more developed the plot, the more accurate the communication.
- **Plot = the arrangement of events in a narrative**. The sequence differs from narrative to narrative (you can begin with the beginning, middle or end); it creates suspense, climax and resolution, then a conclusion.

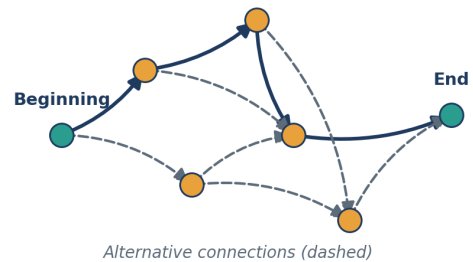
Five types of plot



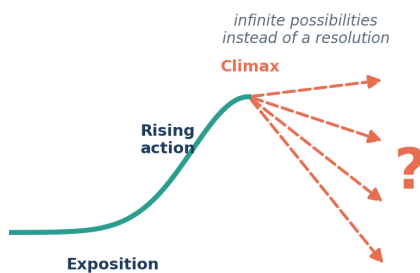
Linear plot: Freytag's pyramid (exposition, rising action, climax, falling action, resolution)



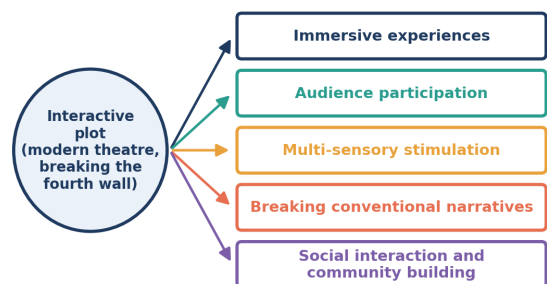
Circular: the Hero's Journey (redrawn schematic)



Non-linear: many epics, contemporary plots



Open-ended: infinite possibilities instead of resolution or catastrophe



Interactive: modern theatre ("The Rise of Interactive Theatre")

Choosing the right plot for yourself: (1) your role and audience expectations, (2) audience's requirements, (3) channels of communication, (4) end goal.

Plot in "Civil Peace" (how the lecture uses the story)

- The story's goal is to present **Nigeria, Nigerians, colonizers' influence on politics and economy, and an emerging nation** in a certain light.
- It does this through **plot** (sequencing ideas and events) and through **language that communicates and invokes images**.

4

Modernism, modern art and Camus

Lecture L4 · Katherine Mansfield's context

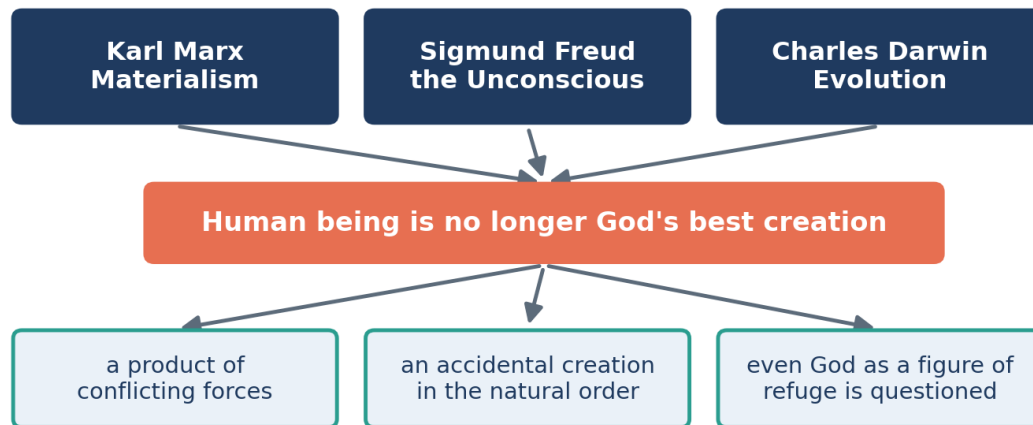
Katherine Mansfield (1888-1923)

- Born in New Zealand to English parents; migrated to England at 19.
- A pre-eminent writer of the English short story, in the **Modernist** tradition.

What Modernism was

- A movement in **Western society**, late 19th to early 20th centuries (**1900-1920s**), shaped by the West's **losing political dominance** over the world and by the **world-war** experience.

- It began as a **rebellion against traditional value systems**: questioning and rejecting ideals such as an all-powerful God and moral codes. It encouraged **re-examination and introspection**.



Precursors of Modernist thought and their consequence for how humans see themselves

Modern art (symbolises change and experimentalism, questions norms; stresses individualism, alienation and existentialism)

Movement / work	Key points from the slides
Cubism	Pablo Picasso, <i>Portrait of Wilhelm Uhde</i> (1910)
Dada	French for ' nonsense '; grew out of the world war. Marcel Duchamp (Dadaist) reworked the Mona Lisa: " Destruction is also creation. " Raoul Hausmann, <i>Mechanical Head (The Spirit of Our Time)</i>
Surrealism	Centred in Paris ; proponents of Dadaism and Surrealism: Marcel Duchamp and André Breton (French artists). Rafał Olbiński (Polish) shown as an example
Magritte	<i>La Reproduction Interdite (The Forbidden Reproduction)</i> : read as colonialists fashioning natives after themselves

The Myth of Sisyphus and Absurdism

- **Sisyphus** was a classical Greek king who cheated the gods and tried to bring immortality to humankind, so **Zeus** punished him. The myth reminds us of human mortality and divine immortality.
- **Albert Camus** (20th-century French philosopher), *The Myth of Sisyphus* (1942): the **absurd** comes with the realization that the world is not rational; at this point humanity stands face to face with the irrational.
- The **absurd hero**; the futility of human efforts to gain clarity and meaning in an absurd, godless world. Camus's philosophy lies **beyond despair and hope**.
- The slide links loneliness, individualism and empowerment to the Western worldview, in contrast to Eastern cultures that celebrate communal duties and community over the individual.

5

The two stories at a glance

Lectures L3 and L5 · no direct questions expected, but useful for comprehension passages

	Civil Peace (Achebe)	The Fly (Mansfield)
Setting	Post-war Nigeria (Biafran war aftermath); Africa: poverty, struggle for survival, loss	Post-war Europe: wealth, emotional trauma
Central figure	Jonathan Iwegbu, a war survivor who counts himself lucky	The boss, proud, successful, healthy but alone; old Woodifield has a family but is poor
Shared ground	War victims; grieving fathers; loss and trauma	War victims; grieving fathers of sons lost to conscription
Plot shape	Opening sentence sets a lucky, thankful tone; small material gains (bicycle, house, family businesses); high point = the windfall (ex gratia, "egg-rasher"); caution and joy foretell mishap; the robbery; the family's stoic morning-after return to business	Starts with the two men "snug" in the parlor; contrast is set but so is similarity; we hear of the boss's love for his son late; we wait to see him grieve; instead he watches a fly, is deeply cruel, and kills it; he forgets his trauma, numbed
Style / device	Repetition of "Nothing puzzles God!"; the ironic title; heroism of ordinary people	Contrast between the two old men; the fly episode as a substitute for grief
Big idea	Human resilience and optimism amid devastation	Loss of human emotion due to war

Lecture point about beginnings: the opening of "Civil Peace" ("counted himself extra-ordinarily lucky... 'Happy survival!'") sets the tone. The lecture asks you to imagine a different beginning, such as the robbery or the rubble around the house, and notice how the tone would change. **Plot choices shape tone.**

6

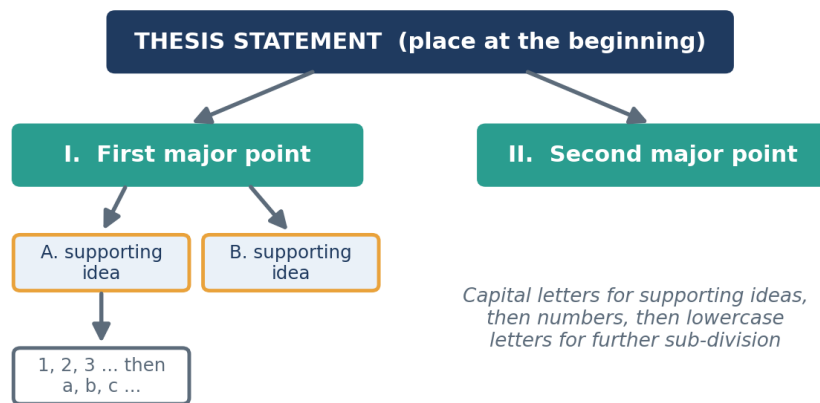
Arguments and scholarly communication

Lecture L6

Constructing arguments

- **Keywords: 5-7.** Form a potential thesis / topic sentence (the main point of view) in **25-30 words**. Then organise ideas in an outline.
- A thesis, per the Cambridge Dictionary, is a long piece of writing on a particular subject, especially for a higher college or university degree.
- Thesis statements, from a statement to an essay: for "An analysis of the college admission process reveals *one challenge* faced by counselors..." the essay should explain **both** the analysis and the challenge. For "High school graduates should take a year off for community service..." the essay must present an **argument with evidence**.

Outline and stages of argument formation



Outline labelling: thesis, then I / II, then A / B, then 1 / 2 / 3, then a / b / c

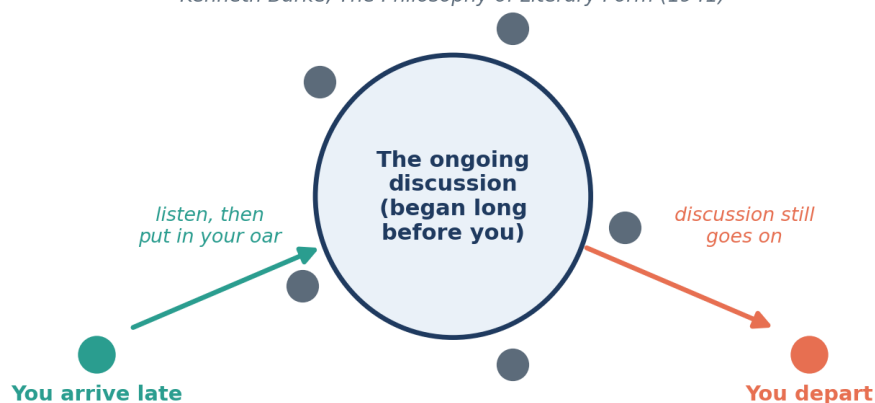
- Stages: **Main point** (good topic sentence or clear introduction) → 1. first main line of argument → A. first sub-argument → i), ii), iii) proofs → B. second sub-argument, and so on.

Points to remember (formal writing)

- Your arguments must be sensitive to **glocal** requirements.
- To disagree with someone in formal communication, use **facts and evidence**.
- Avoid personal attacks and remarks.
- Use humour only to **defuse difficult situations**; never to mock or put down people in formal writing.

Scholarly communication: building knowledge systems

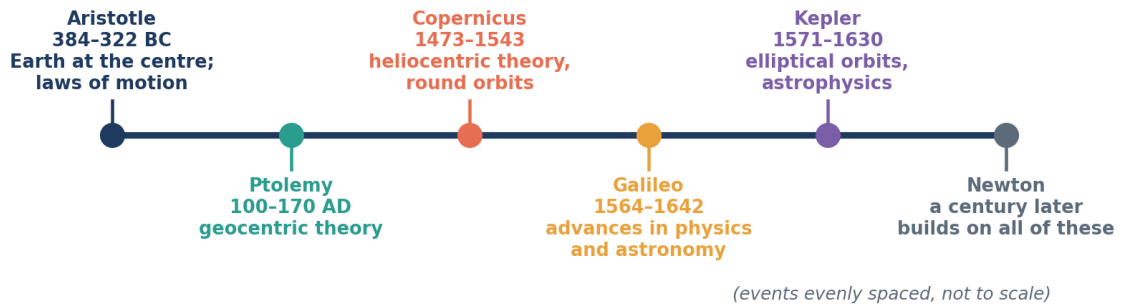
Kenneth Burke, *The Philosophy of Literary Form* (1941)



The Burkean parlor

- Parlor** = a place for receiving guests; from Anglo-Norman French *parlur* ('place for speaking'), from Latin *parlare* ('speak').
- Kenneth Burke's image: you enter a discussion that began long before you; nobody can retrace it all for you; you listen, then join in; allies and opponents respond; the hour grows late and you leave, but the discussion carries on.
- Burkean parlor of scholarly communication:** scholarly communication matters over time and generations; accurately recording data is key to creating systems of knowledge; accuracy depends on how data is presented (plotted, argued, archived); we are all **filling gaps** in existing scholarship as we add new ideas, concepts and data sets.
- Knowledge systems** do not exist in a vacuum; they develop over time and converse with older ones, and newer knowledge is born through that continuum. Scholarly recording is key to **synthesising new ideas from older ones**.

Worked example of that continuum: from Aristotle to Newton



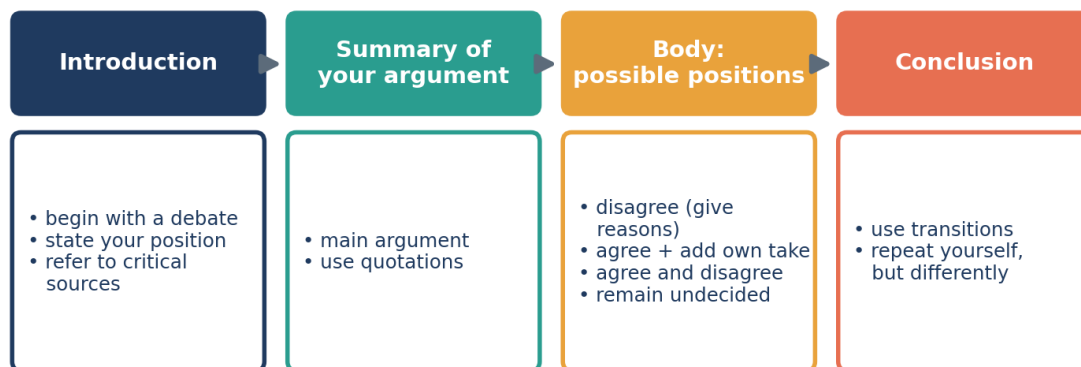
Planet Earth: each thinker responds to the earlier ones

Copernicus's followers, such as Bruno, were burnt by the Church for heresy. Kepler contributed elliptical orbits and advances in astrophysics; Newton in England built on these a century later.

7

Writing an essay: templates and style manuals

Lecture L7 · templates from Graff and Birkenstein, They Say, I Say



Structure of the essay, following the L7 slides

Style manuals across disciplines

Field	Manuals
Technical and scientific research writing	IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers) manual; APA (American Psychological Association) manual
Social sciences and humanities	MLA Handbook; Chicago Style Manual; Harvard Style Manual; APA Style Manual

Template moves (the slides fill these in with Achebe and "Civil Peace")

Part	Move	Shape of the template
Introduction	Begin with a debate	"In discussing X, one often claims ____ (Author, page). On the one hand, ____ argue _____. On the other hand, ____ contend _____. Others maintain _____. My own view is _____."
Introduction	State your position	"I've always believed that ____ has had its merits and demerits... Reading the story I cannot help thinking _____. At the same time, I believe ____ and also _____."
Introduction	Refer to critical sources	"A number of scholars have suggested that _____. It has become common today to state _____. In their recent work A and B claim _____." Cite as you go.
Summary	Main argument and quotations	"[Author] hails ____ and his hero presents a glorious example of ____ by _____. He admits: '____'. Accordingly, I reaffirm _____."
Body	Disagree, with reasons	"Scholar A is mistaken about ____ because she ignores the fact that _____." / "I disagree with A's view that ____ because recent studies have revealed _____."
Body	Agree and add your own take	"I agree that X's views on ____; this is because my own experience ____ confirms it." / "X's theory is extremely useful here because it sheds light on _____."
Body	Agree and disagree at once	"Though I concede ____, I still insist that _____." / "While the author is perhaps too idealistic when he states ____, he is right when he _____."
Body	Remain undecided	"I am on two minds about _____. On the one hand I agree that _____. On the other hand, I am not sure whether _____."
Conclusion	Repeat yourself, but differently	"In sum, my argument is _____." / "To conclude, I would like to reiterate that _____." / "By realistically depicting the perils ____, the author reaffirms the age-old philosophy that _____."

Transitions for the conclusion: as a result · after all · in short · finally · to summarize · in sum · simply put. **Whenever you cite or borrow, give a reference in parentheses** following the style manual you are working with.

8

Writing well: final points

Lecture L8 · Written communication

The slides open with a montage of early humans, cave paintings and an inscribed tablet under the heading **Good communication: effective problem solving since the dawn of civilization**. The rest of the lecture is about writing choices.

What is central to good writing

Sequencing of ideas



Grammar



Sequencing of ideas, then grammar

Writerly writing: the erroneous sentence (common mistakes)

Sentence on the slide	Error the slide names
"Being the most spectacular event in the nation, newspapers were obligated to devote major coverage to the hurricane."	The opening phrase attaches to the wrong noun: newspapers were not the most spectacular event (a modifier problem)
"He had arrive at his home town."	Tense (wrong verb form after 'had')
"Either the physicians in this hospital or the chief administrator are going to have to make a decision."	Subject-verb agreement (with either/or the verb agrees with the nearer subject, so 'is')

Complex academic writing and creative writing

- **Complex theoretical/academic writing:** the slide shows a dense, abstract passage from Michel Foucault's *Discipline and Punish* (1977), arguing that the soul is an effect and instrument of political power ("the soul is the prison of the body"). It is the opposite of readerly writing.
- **Creative writing:** examples from Arundhati Roy's *The God of Small Things*. A **simile** compares one thing with another of a different kind to make a description more emphatic or vivid: a face pale and wrinkled like a dhobi's thumb after too long in water; still birds sliding along moving wires like unclaimed baggage at an airport; history's smell like old roses on a breeze.
- **Neologisms** (newly invented words) from the same book: "getting-outedness", "Bar Nowl", "viable-dieable age".

Verb tenses

- **Northern Illinois University:** in formal writing keep verb tenses consistent so readers can follow ideas and arguments. **In creative writing tenses may be inconsistent for effect**, but in academic writing be consistent throughout and signal any necessary shift.
- **Purdue OWL:** unnecessary or inconsistent shifts cause confusion; writers generally keep **one tense for the main discourse**; a change in time frame is shown by changing tense **relative to the primary tense** (usually simple past or simple present); even non-narrative writing needs consistent, clear tenses.
- **Consistency and elegance:** sentences must be balanced and consistent. Errors involve verb and pronoun usage. If a sentence begins in the past tense it must stay there. Do not shift tense if the time frame is the same. Example on the slide: "*The instructor explains the diagram to students who asked questions during the lecture*" mixes present and past.
- **Pronouns** must be consistent in person and number; a shift from singular *I* to plural *we* leaves the reader unsure who is doing what.
- **Incorrect tenses (worked example):** a passage about Elizabeth Peabody uses *was*, *felt*, *thrived* (past) with *trains*, *seems* (present). All the action happened in the past, so all verbs should be past.

Parallel structure

X Juan loves skating and to read.

skating (participle) vs to read (infinitive):
the pair is not grammatically parallel

✓ Juan loves skating and reading.

✓ Juan loves to skate and to read.

Change either item so both follow the same pattern

Pairs and lists must follow the same grammatical pattern

- Parallel structure involves pairs and lists of words and phrases; **all items must follow the same grammatical pattern**.
- Journalism example: the list *reading, watching, and you should read* breaks the pattern. Fix: *reading a variety of newspapers, watching documentaries and televised news programs, and reading books about world leaders...*
- Parallelism example: *the more I read..., the more it makes me want...* is faulty because the phrases after "the more" are not grammatical equivalents. *It makes me* should be matched with *I want to*: **the more I**

read..., the more I want to get out there and try it.

Active and passive voice

ACTIVE (direct, shorter)



PASSIVE (subject is acted upon; wordy, lacks focus)



Compare the two sentences in each pair from the slide

- In the passive voice the **subject is acted upon**. Passive constructions tend to be wordy or lack focus, so most sentences should be active.
- More pairs on the slide: *I misplaced my wallet / My wallet was misplaced by me; The administration has selected three finalists / Three finalists have been selected by the administration.*

When passive voice is acceptable (University of Toronto advice on the slides)

- **The actor is unknown:** the cave paintings of Lascaux were made in the Upper Old Stone Age.
- **The actor is irrelevant:** an experimental solar power plant will be built in the Australian desert.
- **You want to be vague about who is responsible:** "Mistakes were made" (common in bureaucratic writing).
- **You are talking about a general truth:** rules are made to be broken.

Readerly writing checklist: simple and precise · sticks to the rules of grammar · chronological · without contradictions · without complexity.

9

Writing rules, AI ethics and plagiarism

From the writing lecture notes

Common mistake	What it means	Example from the notes
Tenses (discontinuity)	Switching between past, present and future without reason	"Once upon a time there was a king. He is the greatest monarch... he will be planning a war..."
Use active voice	Make the doer the subject	Weak: "When John offers Tim's mother to help with his education, she becomes liberated of a burden." Better: "When John offers to educate Tim, he relieves his mother of a burden."
Excessive wordiness / repetition	Saying the same thing twice	"children are curious and often of mischievous attitude" (Tagore example)
Incomplete / incongruous sentences	A sentence promises something it never delivers	"On the other hand, Tagore feels..." with no earlier "on the one hand"
Too many ideas in one sentence	Split it up	Long Tagore sentence packing the child's growth, family finance, widowed mother and moral codes into one line
Gender-sensitive writing	Be gender inclusive	Avoid: "If one seeks to learn what interests him , he would..."
Avoid abbreviations	Write things out in formal prose	&, etc., e.g.

Generative AI and plagiarism

- GenAI is programmed to generate answers whether or not it has appropriate ones. **Students cannot blame AI for errors**; they remain accountable for everything they submit.
- AI can carry **bias or inaccuracy** and can strengthen and magnify existing biases in its training data. **Human supervision is critical.**
- Ethical use: **ensure attribution, double-check against bias**, and provide education and training for researchers and recipients.
- **Plagiarism = unacknowledged copying.** Using archival or existing critical data is fully accepted, but **acknowledgement is mandatory.**

10

Comprehension-passage tips

General exam technique, not from the slides

- **Read the questions first**, then the passage, so you know what to hunt for.
- Find the **main idea and the author's purpose** in one sentence before you look at options. The lectures keep asking: what is the goal of this text and how does the plot or structure achieve it?
- Look for **tone** and where it shifts. Lecture examples: an ironic title, a hopeful opening line that sets the tone, contrast between two characters.
- Answer **only from the passage**. Options that sound true in general but are not supported by the text are usually the trap.
- Be wary of extreme words (always, never, only, all) unless the passage is equally extreme.
- Use the lecture vocabulary: plot, exposition, climax, resolution, irony, tone, thesis, argument, evidence, audience, purpose, bias.
- There is **no negative marking**, so guess when unsure after eliminating what you can.

11

Practice MCQs (50 questions)

Do it cold, then check the key that follows

1. What is the order of the communication process in the L2 slides?

- A.** Sender → Encoded message → Receiver → Decoded message
- B.** Sender → Receiver → Encoded message → Decoded message
- C.** Encoded message → Sender → Decoded message → Receiver
- D.** Receiver → Encoded message → Sender → Decoded message

3. Which is NOT one of Aristotle's common topics on the slide?

- A.** Narration
- B.** Testimony
- C.** Comparison
- D.** Definition

5. Cause, effect, antecedent, consequence and contraries fall under:

- A.** Definition
- B.** Testimony
- C.** Relationship
- D.** Circumstance

7. Brainstorming is described as primarily:

- A.** statistical
- B.** intuitive
- C.** legalistic
- D.** solitary

9. Which is NOT part of 'Identifying Audiences and Purposes'?

- A.** Uses of your communication and the routes it will travel
- B.** Impact of co-operative, controversial and ethical ideas
- C.** Impact of distortion, incompleteness, inaccuracy and bias
- D.** Choosing the font size of the final document

11. Achebe's position on African storytelling traditions was:

- A.** both oral storytelling and Negritude
- B.** only written literature
- C.** only Negritude
- D.** neither

2. Wordsworth's Preface to Lyrical Ballads (1800) describes poetry as:

- A.** the imitation of nature
- B.** the spontaneous overflow of powerful feelings
- C.** the music of reason
- D.** a mirror held up to society

4. Authority, testimonials, statistics, maxims, law, precedents and examples fall under:

- A.** Relationship
- B.** Comparison
- C.** Testimony
- D.** Circumstance

6. Possible, impossible, past fact and future fact fall under:

- A.** Relationship
- B.** Comparison
- C.** Definition
- D.** Circumstance

8. Good communication is often:

- A.** the mere conveying of information
- B.** free of audience concerns
- C.** a one-way transfer
- D.** socially negotiated problem solving

10. Negritude began:

- A.** in the United States in the 1960s
- B.** in France, by the African diaspora in the 1930s
- C.** in Britain in the 18th century
- D.** in Nigeria after 1970

12. The Nigerian civil war (Nigerian-Biafran war) took place in:

- A.** 1958-61
- B.** 1967-70
- C.** 1939-45
- D.** 1914-18

13. The chief causes of the Nigerian civil war were:

- A.** a war against France
- B.** cultural and economic, from an arbitrary division of the continent by the British
- C.** purely religious
- D.** a dispute over a single election

15. In Freytag's pyramid, what comes right after the climax?

- A.** Rising action
- B.** Falling action
- C.** Exposition
- D.** Interactive phase

17. An open-ended narrative plot is one where:

- A.** the ending is always tragic
- B.** the audience decides the middle
- C.** the end may have infinite possibilities instead of a resolution
- D.** the story loops back to the start

19. Which is NOT a factor in choosing the right plot?

- A.** End goal
- B.** The writer's birthplace
- C.** Your role and audience expectations
- D.** Channels of communication

21. The Modernist movement is dated roughly to:

- A.** 1800–1830
- B.** 1950–1970
- C.** 1900–1920s
- D.** 1600–1650

23. Proponents of Dadaism and Surrealism named on the slide were:

- A.** Pablo Picasso and Claude Monet
- B.** Camus and Sartre
- C.** Marcel Duchamp and André Breton
- D.** Kepler and Galileo

25. Camus's *The Myth of Sisyphus* was published in:

- A.** 1971
- B.** 1942
- C.** 1800
- D.** 1958

27. In an outline, major points supporting the thesis are labelled with:

- A.** numbers (1, 2, 3)
- B.** Roman numerals (I, II, III)
- C.** lowercase letters (a, b, c)
- D.** capital letters (A, B, C)

14. Plot is best defined as:

- A.** the author's biography
- B.** the setting of a story
- C.** the moral of a story
- D.** the arrangement of events in a narrative

16. A circular plot is illustrated by:

- A.** a Freytag pyramid
- B.** the Hero's Journey (e.g. *The Ramayana*)
- C.** a contemporary non-linear film
- D.** interactive theatre

18. Interactive plot is associated with:

- A.** Freytag's pyramid
- B.** letters and memos
- C.** medieval epics
- D.** modern theatre that breaks the fourth wall

20. Which pairing of precursor and idea is correct?

- A.** Marx: Evolution
- B.** Freud: Materialism
- C.** Darwin: Materialism
- D.** Freud: the Unconscious

22. 'Dada' is French for:

- A.** nonsense
- B.** dream
- C.** father
- D.** machine

24. For Camus, the absurd arises from:

- A.** a belief in progress
- B.** the realization that the world is not rational
- C.** the rejection of all art
- D.** a lack of education

26. The slides suggest keywords and thesis length of:

- A.** 2–3 keywords; 5-word thesis
- B.** 10–15 keywords; 100-word thesis
- C.** 5–7 keywords; 25–30 word thesis
- D.** no set length

28. The Burkean parlor is a metaphor for:

- A.** private note-taking
- B.** a formal debate with a winner
- C.** a place to store archives
- D.** scholarly conversation that began before you and continues after you leave

29. Which thinker proposed the heliocentric theory?

- A.** Ptolemy
- B.** Aristotle
- C.** Copernicus
- D.** Newton

31. "Once upon a time there was a king. He is the greatest monarch of all times." illustrates which mistake?

- A.** Tense discontinuity
- B.** Gender bias
- C.** Too many ideas in one sentence
- D.** Passive voice

33. Which manuals are listed for technical and scientific research writing?

- A.** Harvard only
- B.** None
- C.** IEEE and APA
- D.** MLA and Chicago

35. Plagiarism is defined in the notes as:

- A.** quoting with a citation
- B.** unacknowledged copying
- C.** paraphrasing with a citation
- D.** using any critical data

37. 'Either the physicians ... or the chief administrator are going to have to make a decision.' The slide names the error as:

- A.** Pronoun shift
- B.** Subject-verb agreement
- C.** Tense
- D.** Parallelism

39. A simile is:

- A.** a newly invented word
- B.** a repeated phrase
- C.** the use of the passive voice
- D.** a comparison of one thing with another of a different kind to make description more vivid

41. According to the tense slides, verb tenses may be used inconsistently for effect in:

- A.** technical manuals
- B.** academic writing
- C.** formal reports
- D.** creative writing

30. According to the L6 points to remember, humour in formal writing:

- A.** is encouraged to mock opponents
- B.** should be used only to defuse difficult situations
- C.** should never be used at all
- D.** is fine when the audience agrees

32. "If one seeks to learn what interests him, he would..." is a problem because it is:

- A.** incomplete
- B.** too wordy
- C.** in the passive voice
- D.** not gender inclusive

34. According to the notes on generative AI, who is accountable for errors in submitted work?

- A.** The AI
- B.** Nobody
- C.** The student
- D.** The university library

36. The sentence 'He had arrive at his home town' has which error, according to the slide?

- A.** Subject-verb agreement
- B.** Passive voice
- C.** Parallel structure
- D.** Tense

38. In 'Being the most spectacular event in the nation, newspapers were obligated to devote major coverage to the hurricane', what is wrong?

- A.** The opening phrase wrongly describes the newspapers
- B.** It lacks a subject
- C.** The verb tense is inconsistent
- D.** It uses passive voice

40. Neologisms (as in 'Bar Nowl' from The God of Small Things) are:

- A.** grammatical equivalents
- B.** newly invented words
- C.** errors of tense
- D.** words borrowed from Latin

42. Purdue OWL says writers indicate a change in time frame by:

- A.** changing tense relative to the primary tense
- B.** switching pronouns
- C.** starting a new paragraph
- D.** using the passive voice

43. 'The instructor explains the diagram to students who asked questions during the lecture' is a problem because:

- A.** it shifts tense within the same time frame
- B.** it is in the passive voice
- C.** the subject is missing
- D.** it uses too many adjectives

45. 'The more I read about deep sea fishing, the more it makes me want...' is faulty because:

- A.** it uses passive voice
- B.** the phrases after 'the more' are not grammatical equivalents
- C.** it changes tense
- D.** it is too long

47. Which is an acceptable use of the passive, per the University of Toronto slide?

- A.** Three finalists were selected by the administration.
- B.** The cave paintings of Lascaux were made in the Upper Old Stone Age (actor unknown).
- C.** Another helping was asked for by my friend.
- D.** My wallet was misplaced by me (actor obvious).

49. Which set describes 'readerly writing' on the slide?

- A.** Dense, abstract and theory-heavy
- B.** Full of invented words and unusual similes
- C.** Simple and precise, grammatical, chronological, without contradictions or complexity
- D.** Written mainly in the passive voice

44. Which sentence is grammatically parallel?

- A.** Juan loves to skate and reading.
- B.** Juan loves skating and reading.
- C.** Juan loves skate and to read.
- D.** Juan loves skating and to read.

46. Which sentence is in the passive voice?

- A.** The administration has selected three finalists.
- B.** My wallet was misplaced by me.
- C.** My friend asked for another helping.
- D.** I misplaced my wallet.

48. 'Mistakes were made' illustrates passive voice used when:

- A.** you are stating a general truth
- B.** you want to be vague about who is responsible
- C.** the actor is unknown
- D.** the actor is irrelevant

50. Which is NOT part of 'Sequencing of ideas' in the L8 slide?

- A.** Know the existing conversation
- B.** Collect ideas
- C.** Algorithmic progression of argument
- D.** Choosing a font



Answer key

With a one-line reason for each

#	Ans	Why
1	A	The chain runs sender, encoded message, receiver, decoded message.
2	B	Origin: emotion recollected in tranquility.
3	A	The five are Definition, Comparison, Relationship, Circumstance, Testimony.
4	C	That whole list is under Testimony.
5	C	Relationship.
6	D	Circumstance.
7	B	Also collaborative, many perspectives, leads to evaluation and organisation.
8	D	The slide says communication is not merely conveying information.
9	D	Font size is not on the slide.
10	B	Against French racism and rule.
11	A	Both.
12	B	1967–70.
13	B	Cultural and economic.
14	D	Arrangement of events; the sequence differs from narrative to narrative.
15	B	Order: exposition, rising, climax, falling, resolution.
16	B	Circular: Hero's Journey.
17	C	No fixed resolution or catastrophe.
18	D	Audience participation, immersive experiences.
19	B	Four factors: role/audience expectations, audience's requirements, channels, end goal.
20	D	Marx: Materialism; Freud: Unconscious; Darwin: Evolution.
21	C	Late 19th to early 20th centuries.
22	A	Dada arose in the wake of the world war.
23	C	French artists.
24	B	Humanity stands face to face with the irrational.
25	B	1942.
26	C	Keywords 5–7; thesis 25–30 words.
27	B	Then capital letters for supporting ideas, then numbers, then lowercase.
28	D	Kenneth Burke, 1941.
29	C	Ptolemy was geocentric.
30	B	Never to mock or put down people.
31	A	Past, present and future are mixed.
32	D	Use gender-inclusive language.
33	C	MLA, Chicago, Harvard and APA are for social sciences and humanities.
34	C	Students cannot blame AI.
35	B	Acknowledgement is mandatory.
36	D	The slide labels it a tense error.
37	B	With either/or, the verb agrees with the nearer subject.
38	A	Newspapers were not the most spectacular event; the hurricane was.
39	D	Arundhati Roy's similes were the slide examples.
40	B	Neo = new; logos = word.
41	D	Academic writing should be consistent and signal any shifts.

#	Ans	Why
42	A	The primary tense is usually simple past or simple present.
43	A	Explains (present) and asked (past) describe the same time frame.
44	B	Skating/to read mixes a participle with an infinitive.
45	B	'It makes me' should be matched with 'I want to'.
46	B	The subject (wallet) is acted upon.
47	B	Passive works when the actor is unknown, irrelevant, to be left vague, or for a general truth.
48	B	Common in bureaucratic writing.
49	C	Readerly = easy for the reader to follow.
50	D	The list: collect ideas, know the existing conversation, keywords, thesis statement, algorithmic progression.